

Outlook

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Audit sample: activity after account closure - 2023 control review

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Internal Audit wants to test whether an account status change consistently stops transactions, ATM access, debit orders, collections and campaigns. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if manual exceptions are not documented consistently?
2. What evidence would instead support that some downstream systems lag?
3. How do we rule out that controls propagate on the same day?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use October 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards whether this is an isolated exception, a design weakness or a control operating failure. A useful output would be a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline.

Use monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; collections cases, promises to pay and recovery payments; campaign design and customer responses. One caution: The result is a data-based control test and still requires process-owner evidence.

Regards